prerequisites to achieve success in the field of semiconductors. For this, we are focused on the right mix of policies, incentives and skilling. We have taken giant leaps in our semiconductor manufacturing mission. Our focus is now on bringing in the entire ecosystem of electronics manufacturing to India, which includes the entire value chain. We are working towards creating a favourable and enabling environment for this.

Q. What about AI?

We also want India to take the lead in the field of artificial intelligence (AI). We will be working on our own computing power in large indigenous language models, keeping in mind the diversity of Indian languages and our needs. This leadership in technology also requires a shift in mindsets. Today, from classrooms to boardrooms, we are ensuring the focus is on innovation and easy availability of capital along with progressive and stable policies. Remember, today's innovation is tomorrow's industry. And it is industry that brings investment and income growth.

Q. Coming to international issues, you have won worldwide praise for the successful presidency of the G20 and for bringing issues of the Global South to the fore. What do nations have to do now to sustain the gains of Delhi 2023?

Our G20 presidency came at a time of multiple and interlinked global challenges. I am happy that we were able to put the focus on human-centric development in the global agenda. We got the developed and developing world to forge a consensus. We revitalised multilateralism. Developing countries, in particular, have been significantly impacted by slowing global growth, rising debt, climate change and geopolitical conflicts. Our presidency became a platform to provide a rightful place to the Global South in shaping the global narrative. The induction of the African Union as a permanent member of G20 in New Delhi was a landmark decision that has given voice to 55 African nations. G20 has emerged stronger and more purposeful during India's presidency, shaping the global agenda more effectively. This is manifested in important outcomes, including on Sustainable Development Goals, LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment initiative), digital public infrastructure, food security and nutrition, renewable energy, critical minerals, global health, skilled migration pathways, climate and development finance, MDB (multilateral development bank) reforms and much more. I am happy to inform you that so many of our decisions and initiatives at the G20 summit are being taken forward. It was towards this end that we convened the second G20 Leaders' Summit, in virtual mode, before the end of our G20 presidency. We also convened the 2nd Voice of Global South Summit in November 2023.

Q. What was the result of the stocktaking done in these meetings?

It is good to see that many of the G20 achievements on energy and climate in New Delhi, such as tripling global renewable energy capacity [by 2030], developing hydrogen [as a fuel], and scaling up climate and energy finance, were echoed and carried forward at COP28 in Dubai. The G20 message on AI on pro-innovation governance and regulation has been cemented at subsequent international gatherings, including the Global Partnership on AI conference that we hosted earlier this month. MDB reforms, to help scale up climate and developmental finance, and making MDBs more representative, is now at the heart of the agenda of international financial institutions. Mechanisms on women-led development, disaster risk reduction and start-ups, created during our presidency, are being taken forward by the Brazilian G20 presidency. India, as a member of the G20 troika, will make constructive contributions



"The Modi way of dealing with our neighbours is to be cooperative when required and, equally, to be firm and steadfast when needed. On both initiatives and challenges, you can see the difference with the past"